

WHERE DO PHOBIAS COME FROM?

Yikes! About one in ten people suffers from a phobia. Whether the fear takes the form of an object, activity, or situation, it always induces an overwhelming sense of terror. Most phobias are thought to be learned as children—seeing others express a fear of something makes us more likely to become scared of it, too. As identical twins often share phobias, genes may also play a role. Another theory is that phobias develop from a bad experience in early life, which never goes away.



BRONTOPHOBIA
Fear of thunderstorms

ROAD TO TERROR

COMMON PHOBIAS

There is a difference between phobias and dislikes of things. A person should experience genuine fear of something in order for it to be classed as an actual phobia. People are most likely to have a phobia involving disease, dangerous situations, or animals. While the first two are understandable, the latter is more complex. Psychologists think that the fear of certain animals stems from our evolutionary past, when deadly or aggressive creatures were a real threat, and people still have the genes that can trigger fear of them. Brace yourself for some of the most common phobias around...



VERTIGO
Fear of heights



ICHTHYOPHOBIA
Fear of fish



OPHIDIOPHOBIA
Fear of snakes



ALEKTOROPHOBIA
Fear of birds



AILUROPHOBIA
Fear of cats



MUSOPHOBIA
Fear of mice and rats



ARACHNOPHOBIA
Fear of spiders



BATRACHOPHOBIA
Fear of amphibians



MYRMECOPHOBIA
Fear of ants